

Eric McDonald

Cloud Automation & DevOps Engineer

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Location: Toronto, ON

Cloud Automation & DevOps Engineer with 4+ years of experience building OpenShift platforms, CI/CD automation, observability systems, and infrastructure tooling at Bell Canada. Experienced migrating microservices from Rancher and VMware to OpenShift, centralizing secrets with HashiCorp Vault, and standardizing delivery with GitLab CI, Helm, and ArgoCD. Strong background in Python automation, Kubernetes operations, Linux, incident response, and platform reliability.

Skills:

- **Cloud & Containers:** OpenShift, Kubernetes, Docker, Podman, Rancher, OpenStack, VMware, AWS, GCP
- **CI/CD & GitOps:** GitLab CI, ArgoCD, Flux, Helm, Git
- **Automation & Scripting:** Python, Bash, Ansible, StackStorm, Linux
- **Observability:** Prometheus, Grafana, OpenTelemetry, Jaeger, Elasticsearch, Kibana, Zabbix
- **Secrets & Identity:** HashiCorp Vault, Active Directory, LDAP
- **Databases:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, DB2, MongoDB
- **Programming:** Java, C#, C++, Node.js

Experience:

Bell Canada

Cloud Automation Developer II

January 2025 – Present

- Built an OpenShift node validation automation tool using Kubernetes Jobs and pytest across 4 clusters' nodes, reducing daily cluster debugging effort by approximately 5 hours.
- Built a centralized observability platform for 40 services on OpenShift using Prometheus, Elasticsearch, OpenTelemetry, Jaeger, and Grafana, enabling unified troubleshooting across metrics, traces, and logs.
- Deployed and maintained StackStorm-based auto-remediation workflows for Zabbix alerts, ThousandEyes alerts, and Cisco commit log handling, reducing manual operational response effort.
- Migrated approximately 30 microservices from Rancher to OpenShift, improving deployment consistency, platform maintainability, and alignment with Kubernetes-based delivery standards.
- Migrated team CI/CD secrets from GitLab variables to HashiCorp Vault, improving secret management and deployment security.
- Standardized DevOps practices by creating reusable GitLab CI templates, base Helm charts, local development tooling, and centralized ArgoCD workflows.

Bell Canada

Specialist, Software Developer

January 2022 – December 2024

- Refactored Zabbix-related Python automation scripts, improving execution efficiency and reducing code size by 50%.
- Designed, deployed, and maintained a high-availability Elasticsearch and Kibana stack.
- Responded to production incidents and resolved service issues within the same day.
- Centralized GitLab CI pipeline logic into reusable templates to improve consistency across projects.

X-CD Technologies

Software Developer Intern

April 2020 – July 2020

- Developed custom JavaScript and ColdFusion APIs for editing DataTables-based interfaces.
- Built dynamic MySQL-backed web forms and internal administration pages.
- Fixed validation bugs and implemented UI enhancements, including phone number validation.

Rogers Communications

Release Analyst Co-op

September 2019 – December 2019

- Supported enterprise release management using ClearQuest and HP ALM.
- Maintained project status trackers, packaging bulletins, and daily release reports.

Independent Projects:

C++ CI/CD Build Automation

- Built GitLab CI/CD pipelines using Windows and Ubuntu Docker runners to automate builds for low-level C++ systems.
- Configured complex CMake-based library linking and deployment workflows to improve build reliability across environments.

Education:

Seneca College

Advanced Diploma, Computer Programming & Analysis

2017 – 2021

Awards:

- **Bell Canada:** Excellence & Innovation Award
- **Seneca College:** President's Honour List, 4th and 5th semesters